[NON-MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE]

A-A-142B
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SUPERSEDING
A-A-142A
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# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

# CORRECTABLE TYPEWRITER RIBBONS (HIGH YIELD)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers high yield correctable typewriter ribbons for general typing applications and lift-off tape.

## I. Salient characteristics.

A. Ribbons or tapes shall consist of a continuous length of material, and when applicable, have an appropriate leader, trailer, and visible warning signal.

B. Ribbons or tape shall be of the dimensions established by the machine manufacturer for proper operations and the contractor shall certify that the ribbons or tapes are made to the original manufacturers specifications (OEM) unless specified otherwise (see notes in section VIII). The ribbons or tapes shall be firmly, evenly, and uniformly wound in cartridges, or on spools or cores designed for proper operation with the machines specified (see notes).

C. Composition and application of the imaging material shall be such that it does not offset from one layer to the next.

D. When properly installed in accordance with the machine manufacturer's instructions the ribbon or tape shall not tear nor be cut through during the typing operation and take up smoothly, evenly, and completely.

E. The ribbons shall produce black, record copy impressions which are of uniform density, clean, legible and sharp, without smears or smudges and suitable for photo-offset reproduction processes.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited

FSC 7510

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F. Workmanship. The film shall be free from pinholes, tears, streaks, or blisters; the imaging material smoothly and evenly applied and of a uniform thickness; and the finished ribbons free from ragged or nicked edges, foreign matter or other defects which would adversely affect performance or serviceability. Cartridges, spools and cores shall be free from defects which would affect performance or serviceability and which would present a hazard to the user.

G. Shelf Life: Ribbons shall have a minimum shelf life of one year after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling and pass the performance test (see section II).

**II. Performance test**. Select one sample ribbon and place in the machine designated for its use in the contract and operate the machine in the normal manner until the ribbon has run its full course and is wound from one side to the other. The full course shall include reversal and continuous operation for at least one quarter of the return length of the ribbon. During the course of the test operation, the ribbon shall be observed to ensure that it is not binding or twisting so as to interfere with proper printing. Upon completion of the test, the printed matter (the product of the ribbon printing test), shall be examined to ensure that the quality of print is uniformly dark and with no blank spots, light spots, or discontinuities. Failure to comply with any of these requirements shall be cause for rejection.

As an alternative to the prescribed performance test, the contractor may supply a certification from the equipment manufacturer that the ribbon, identified by part number has been tested and shall function properly on the equipment for which it was designed. Selected samples shall then be tested on any compatible printer for the print quality defined above.

If the equipment manufacturer refuses to certify the ribbon, then the ribbon manufacturer may then certify that the ribbon manufacturer (contractor) guarantees that the ribbon shall function properly on the equipment for which it has been designed.

**III. Regulatory requirements.** The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

**IV. Hazardous material requirements.**

A. Toxicity. Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any kno carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful sub shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances a designated in Fed Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the inks conforms to the above require

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B. Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

C. Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

## V. Quality assurance requirements.

A. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see VIII), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Lot definition. Each lot of ribbons shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall be expressed in ribbons manufactured from the same materials, at essentially the same time.

C. Examination of the end item for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one ribbon. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any ribbon containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| Cartridge and ribbon | Not compatible with machine specified |
| Leader signal | Missing |
| Workmanship | See Workmanship paragraph |

D. Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one ribbon. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any ribbon containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

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| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| OEM specifications | Not as specified |
| Width | Not as specified |
| Length | Not as specified |
| Thickness | Not as specified |

E. Sampling of end items for performance tests. The sample unit shall be one ribbon. The sample from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-1. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

1. Performance Testing. The ribbon shall be performance tested in accordance with paragraph II for each lot delivered. If the reject number is reached for the sample size, the lot shall be rejected.

F. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section VI.

**VI. Preparation for delivery.**

A. Packaging, and packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII). The normal commercial number of unit packages shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box used commercially for this item and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage.. The complete pack shall be in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification. The weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

B. Marking. Marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII).

1. For Shipment To Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

2. For Shipment To Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

3. Additional marking. The unit and shipping containers shall include the date of manufacture and the date of reinspection (12 months after the date of manufacture) and the shipping containers, in addition, shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222,

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Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

## VII. Applicable documents.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

A. American Society For Testing Materials (ASTM):

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

D 1777 Standard Test Method for Ribbon Thickness.

B.Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations:
Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials
16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

C.National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., 2200 Mil Rd., Alexandria, VA 22314.

National Motor Freight Classification

D.Uniform Classification Committee Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the National Railroad Freight Committee, Suite 1120, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

Uniform Freight Classification

D. Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions:
Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and GSA Specification Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D streets S.W., Washington, D.C. 20407.

Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

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FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

E. Military Standards:
Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk., Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

## VIII. Notes.

Ordering information. Purchasers should select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(A) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(B) Purchaser shall specify the ribbon dimensions and the machine on which the ribbons are intended to be used.
(C) Purchasers should specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified(See section VI)
(D) Purchasers should specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment, if other than required (See section VI).
(E) Identification marking, if other than required.
(F) If bar code marking is not required.
(G) MSDS's required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.
(H) Purchasers should specify palletization , if required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

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